

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

"THROUGHOUT HISTORY, INDIAN DIETIES AND RULERS HAVE ALWAYS WORN JEWELLERY. THE MODERN IDEA OF MASCULINITY IS AN ANGLICISED VERSION. JEWELLERY MAKES ONE FEEL CONFIDENT AND SEEN. I HAVE FLAUNTED JEWELS FOR MANY YEARS AS THEY BRING OUT MY INNER PEACOCK"

SUVIR SARAN
Chef and writer

project prosperity or for astrological protection. In a "crowded social environment", jewellery becomes a "visual differentiator" for men, says Jhawar. A man who buys jewellery, says Neil Sonawala, managing director at the Mumbai-based Zen Diamonds, is "fashion-conscious and young-at-heart". The male jewellery market has ballooned as a result. Post COVID, jewels have been flying off the shelves for networking dinners, weekend brunches, sporting events and even board meetings. Jewellery for men constitute as much as 35-40 per cent of lifestyle and fashion sales in India now, according to Pooja Madhavan, founder and MD at Limelight Lab Grown Diamonds, and account for 15-25 per cent of the country's jewellery market, per the Indian Bullion and Jeweller Association. Worldwide, men's jewellery is forecast to grow at 9.9 per cent CAGR between 2025 and 2034—against roughly 5 per cent for the overall jewellery market.

CHOOSE YOUR AESTHETIC

Many aesthetics have been out on the prowl. Actors like Shah Rukh Khan and Amitabh Bachchan star in ad campaigns wearing 'elegant but visible' gold and platinum, simple designs that can be worn to office. Baroque jewels have become the go-to for Ranveer Singh, who has become the poster boy for a heritage-forward style and sexuality that aren't bound down by conventional norms. Virat Kohli and Shubman Gill are often on the pitch wearing rings and leather bracelets that convey a quiet strength, while M.S. Dhoni's chains and *kadas* reflect his